

CURRENT AFFAIRS



BEYOND DOKLAM



31st WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

31st July to 6th August, 2017

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO:1

BELT AND ROAD INITIATIVE (BRI)



- BRI is for strengthening Chinese influence over swathes of Asia and Africa so as to become a maritime power.
- Western countries also sent their representatives to attend the BRI conclave.

NEW SILK ROAD ECONOMIC BELT

MOSCOW
RUSSIA

ISTANBUL
TURKEY

VENICE
ITALY

URUMQI
CHINA

BEIJING
CHINA

XI'AN
CHINA

FUZHOU
CHINA

NEW MARITIME SILK ROAD

NAIROBI
KENYA

KUALA LUMPUR
MALAYSIA





MONGOLIA

CHINA

North Korea

South Korea

JAPAN

East China Sea

INDIA

MYANMAR (BURMA)

Lao PDR

NEPAL

KYRGYZSTAN

TAJIKISTAN

AFGHANISTAN

PAKISTAN

KAZAKHSTAN

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 2

GWADAR PORT AND MILITARY BASE



- China is developing the Gwadar port and CPEC is around \$46 billion worth.
- It passes through PoK region.
- China is expected to establish a military base in Gwadar.

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 3

HAMBANTOTA PORT



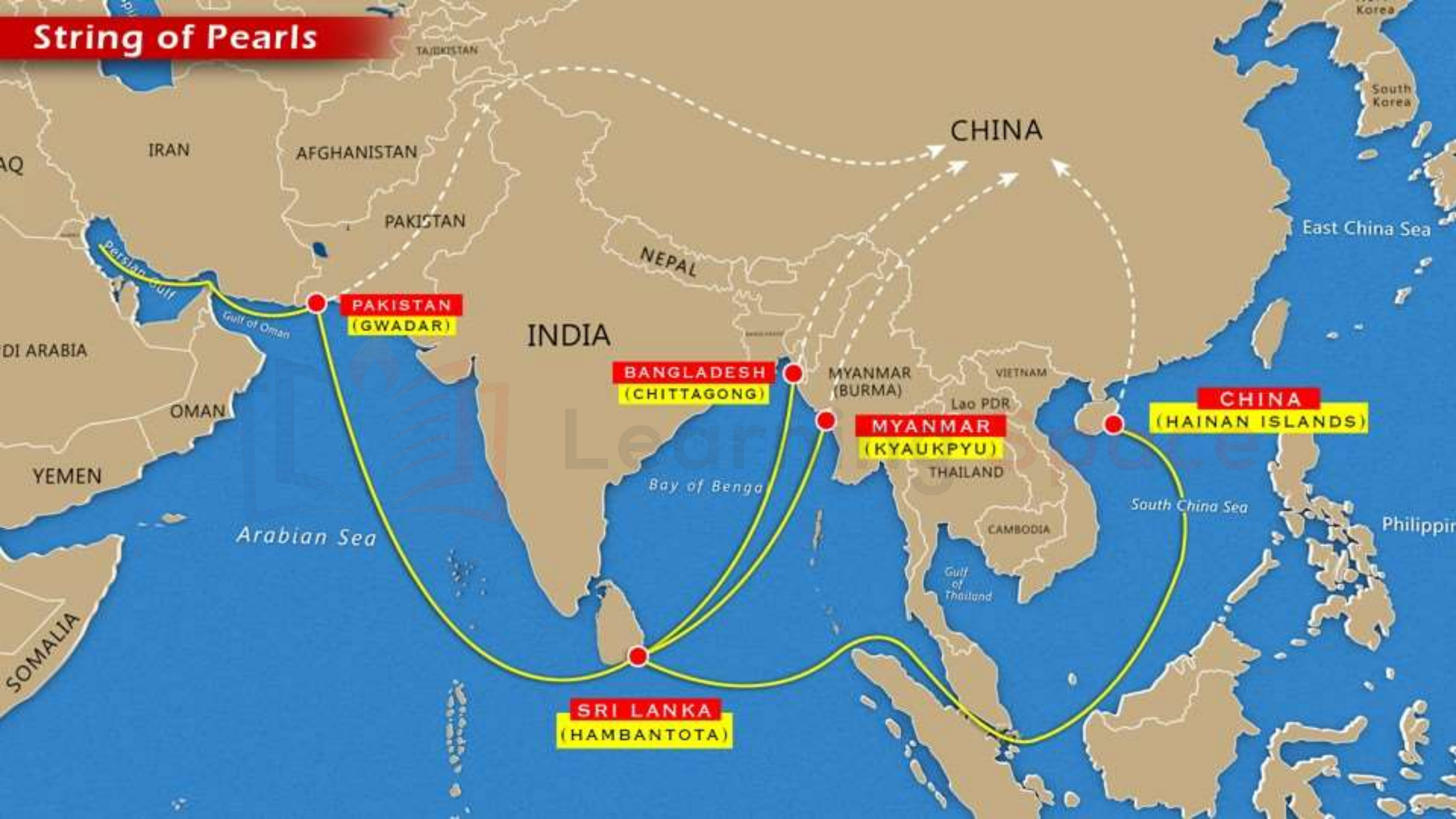
- Sri Lanka has signed a \$ 1.1 bn deal with China Consortium for the control and development of the Southern port of Hambantota.
- Though at present, the security aspects are being looked after by Sri Lanka, but in future, a military base can also come up.



SALIENT POINTS

- The Sri Lankan Govt. has given assurances that China will run only commercial operations from the port, which is situated on the main shipping route between Asia and Europe.
- Under the proposal, a state-run Chinese company will have a 99-year lease on the port and over about 15,000 acres for an industrial zone.
- Hambantota port is expected to play a key role in China's BRI.

String of Pearls



GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 4

NAVAL BASE AT DJIBOUTI



- China formally opened its first military base on the Indian Ocean littoral in the small but strategic African country of Djibouti.

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 5

KYAUKPYU ISLAND DEVELOPMENT



- The Myanmar Government is reportedly close to a deal with a Chinese company for the commercial development of the Kyaukpyu island on its Bay of Bengal coast.
- Once the agreement is through, the Chinese company will start building a deep seaport, Special Economic Zone and an industrial park.
- The expected lease for Kyaukpyu port is going to be 50 to 75 years.

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 6

KYAUKPYU ENERGY GATEWAY



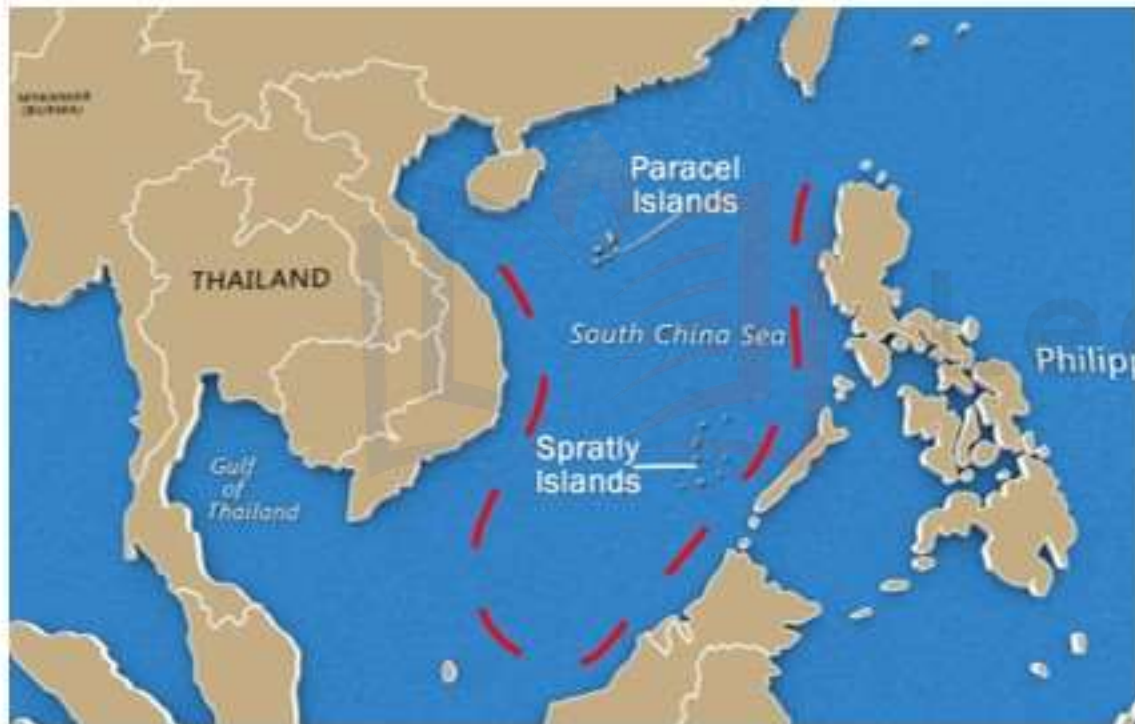
- Kyaukpyu will become the energy gateway for petroleum imports into western China through a twin oil and gas pipeline system running from the Bay of Bengal.
- The project is worth \$10 billion.

China plans to turn Kyaukpyu into a commercial hub like Singapore and Hong Kong.

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 7

SILENCE ON SOUTH CHINA SEA BY PHILIPPINES



- PCA ruled in favour of the Philippines in South China Sea dispute.
- Neither the Philippines nor ASEAN are in a position to implement it.
- Even the verdict of PCA is now in the back burner.
- Meanwhile, Philippines is also seeking billions of dollars of investments/ loans from China.

GLOBAL SCENARIO

ISSUE NO: 8

THE SLOW PACE OF PROGRESS OF CHABAHAR PORT



- The slower pace of progress of Chabahar port made Iran unhappy.
- The relations further strained between India and Iran in recent times.
- Under these circumstances, the future of Chabahar port is not clear.
- In future, it may go into the hands of China also.



WHAT IS THE VIEW POINT OF INDIA ON CHINA?

- 1 India feels that China is embarked upon the strategic encirclement of India. But frankly speaking, China does not have to deliberately contain India.
- 2 China's exercise of its growing comprehensive national power either economic or military will inevitably have that effect.

The question is not about Chinese intentions, but the massive surge in its capabilities.

CHINA'S RISE ... FROM DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVE



Xi Jinping



1

- China, under Xi Jinping, has brought abundant political will to match the expanded national power resources.
- Xi Jinping thinks that the era of China accepting other nations' sensitivities is over.
- It is now others' turn to adapt to Beijing's rise as the foremost power in Asia.

CHINA'S RISE ... FROM DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVE



2

- China's current GDP is five times larger than that of India.
- Its defence spending is three to four times bigger in comparison to India.
- Even if India grows faster than China in the coming years, the huge gap with China will remain unbridged.

CHINA'S RISE ... FROM DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVE



3

- India, probably underestimated the implications of China's rise in the Indian neighbourhood.
- India felt that the border issue may not tilt towards Beijing's favour.
- India also felt that it created sufficiently strong mechanisms to limit conflict on the border.
- Peace and tranquillity on the Sino-Indian border were the consequence of a different set of circumstances, that is when China was integrating itself with the world.
- Now in the changed circumstances, China may become more assertive.

CHINA'S RISE ... FROM DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVE



4

- India had taken its regional primacy for granted all these decades.
- China had never accepted the proposition that the Subcontinent is India's exclusive sphere of influence.
- Now, China has got the sufficient resources to challenge that premise on a routine basis.
- This leaves India scrambling to restore its economic and strategic centrality in the region.



India has to live with the impact of economic might of China over our neighbouring countries, which is seen clearly with projects at Gwadar, Hambantota, Kyaukpyu and other places.

Ultimately, that may lead to the Naval presence in Indian Ocean Region.

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